PARLIAMENT OF ZIMBABWE

Thursday, 9th April, 2026

The National Assembly met at a Quarter-past Two o'clock p.m.

PRAYERS

(THE ACTING. SPEAKER *in the Chair*)

THE ACTING SPEAKER (HON. J. TSHUMA): I have two points of privilege.

HON. KAPOIKILU: Hon. Speaker, I have a point of privilege. Hon. Speaker, about four weeks ago, this House requested a Ministerial Statement from the Minister of Health on Sugar Tax...

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Order, Hon. Member. You have just jumped the gun. You are about to be the one in front of the cat. Let the process say move. We are just beginning the proceedings. I was saying that I have two points of national interest from Hon. Members. The first Hon. Member to take the floor is Hon. Jere.

HON. JERE: I rise today to place on record my heartfelt congratulations and commendations to the Government of Zimbabwe, ably led by the President of the Republic of Zimbabwe, His Excellency

Dr. E. D. Mnangagwa and the Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe for the successful introduction of the renewed Zimbabwe Gold (ZiG) denominations. This development is not merely a currency reform. It is a decisive step in strengthening our monetary sovereignty, restoring confidence in our financial system and advancing the socio-economic transformation of our nation. This development comes against the backdrop of economic stability that has been brought about by financial and fiscal prudence.

The nation has observed that tight monetary policy, strong foreign currency inflows and formidable gold reserves have lowered the premium on the parallel market to around 20%, not forgetting a single-digit inflation rate of 1.3%, which is quite record-breaking and brings stability. The new currency reforms also come at a time when annual inflation was set at 4.4% in March 2026, which is a remarkable milestone in our nation's history.

Mr. Speaker, I rise to emphasise that no economy is ever fully grown while relying on a currency that is not its own. The strength of a nation's economy lies in the sovereignty of its monetary system. In our

neighbouring countries like Zambia, South Africa and Botswana, the United States dollar is not acceptable for everyday transactions. Instead, visitors are directed to a *bureau de change* to convert their money into the local currency. This practice reflects the confidence those nations have in their own currencies and it is precisely the path Zimbabwe must strengthen through the adoption of our renewed Zimbabwe Gold.

By entrenching the use of our own currency, backed by gold reserves and supported by prudent fiscal and monetary measures, we will restore dignity to our financial system, reduce reliance on foreign currencies and anchor sustainability and economic growth.

I, therefore, commend the Government and the Reserve Bank of Zimbabwe for their foresight in introducing the renewed ZiG denominations, which represent cornerstones of our national economic transformation and realisation of our Vision 2030.

What is most commendable is that this reform is already a living reality. Citizens across the country have begun accessing the new ZiG denominations from Automated Teller Machines (ATMs) and cash is

readily available. This is clear proof that the Government is not only making commitments but is decisively delivering on them.

It is a Government that is walking the talk. What is even more encouraging is the positive reception from the public. Zimbabweans are expressing appreciation for the availability and usability of our new currency, particularly the convenience it brings to everyday transactions. For many, this marks a refreshing departure from challenges that have long been associated with cash shortages and transactional inefficiencies.

This growing public confidence is being built through visible action, consistency and results. When citizens can access their money with ease, transact fairly and plan with certainty, trust in the financial system is naturally restored.

Indeed, the people of Zimbabwe are not just witnessing this reform, they are embracing it. The introduction of the ZiG…

HON. MUSHORIWA: On a point of order!

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Order, Hon. Mushoriwa, I am in the Chair.

HON. MUSHORIWA: I want to raise a point of order.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: On what?

HON. MUSHORIWA: Points of national interest are one minute long according to our Standing Orders. If the Hon. Member wishes to do as he is doing, let him bring a motion so that we debate. We cannot allow a person to violate our Standing Orders.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Hon. Mushoriwa, I want to bring to your attention that as the Chair, I can indulge you.

Hon. Tsvangirai having shown disdain towards the Hon. Speaker.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Alright, no, no, no, we will not allow that. We are not in a beer garden here. Hon. Tsvangirai, we are stepping out of order and we will not allow that in this House. So, to prove a point and teach you a lesson, leave the House. You may leave the House.

Hon. Tsvangirai was escorted out of the Chamber by the Serjeant-at-Arms.

HON. JERE: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir for protecting me. As I conclude, the introduction of the small ZiG denominations will go a long

way in alleviating persistent problems of change in transactions. I so submit, thank you.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: The issue that you have brought to the House is very pertinent indeed. I am sure Hon. Members will remember that His Excellency the President of the country actually began this journey when we saw him visit the RBZ vault where we saw the stock of gold and because of policies that were prudent, our gold reserves kept on rising to form the stability that we experience today as a nation.

So, indeed, we need to applaud all the efforts made by all the relevant departments because the country, without a currency, is actually in fragments. Having our currency is going to help with the cost of production and everything. Indeed, it was a very important point of national interest.

HON. MALINGANISO: I rise on a matter of national interest regarding the low and unsustainable prices of tobacco at a time when input costs, particularly fertilisers have risen sharply, placing our farmers under immense economic pressure. While I note that tobacco

prices are beginning to improve with auction averages ranging between approximately USD1.50 and USD2 per kilogramme and contract prices around USD2.70 per kilogramme, these prices remain below the cost of production for the majority of farmers. Although higher prices of up to USD4.60 per kilogramme have been recorded, these are not accessible to the average farmer as they depend largely on grade and market position.

This is happening despite a strong export performance, with Zimbabwe exporting tobacco at an average of USD7.30 per kilogramme. The issue is not production nor is it demand. The issue is value distribution.

I take note of the measures being undertaken by the Government, the Tobacco Industry and Marketing Board, including engagement with buyers, enforcement of participation and efforts to improve competition on the auction floors. However, Mr. Speaker Sir, these measures remain largely market corrective and short-term in nature. The immediate reality is that farmers are still receiving prices that are not commensurate with the cost of production, raising concerns about the adverse effects of

safeguards under the Tobacco Industry and Marketing Act [Chapter 18:20], particularly Section 71, which empowers the fixing of minimum prices.

Furthermore, the structure of the marketing system, especially the dominance of contract arrangements, continues to limit the farmer's share of value, underscoring the need to streamline the value chain and reduce excessive intermediation. This situation poses a direct threat to rural livelihoods, household incomes and the attainment of Vision 2030. I, therefore, urge the Government to complement ongoing efforts with more decisive farmer-centred interventions, including the effective enforcement of minimum price mechanisms, strengthened oversight of contract systems and measures to ensure that farmers receive a fair and sustainable return.

When the farmer earns below the cost of production, it is not just a market failure; it is a national concern. In this regard, I respectively call upon the Hon. Minister responsible for agriculture, to deliver a Ministerial Statement to this House clarifying how current measures will translate into fair and sustainable prices for all farmers and whether

additional interventions, including the application of minimum price mechanisms under Section 71, will be considered if current conditions persist. I so submit and I thank you.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Again, it is a very pertinent issue and we will definitely ask the Minister to issue that statement accordingly. Thank you.

ANNOUNCEMENTS BY THE ACTING SPEAKER

SWITCHING OFF CELLPHONES

THE ACTING SPEAKER: As a matter of housekeeping, Hon. Members, you are reminded that your phones must always be on silent mode so that we do not disturb the House proceedings.

PRESENTATION OF POINTS OF NATIONAL INTEREST

THE ACTING SPEAKER: As a matter of aligning issues, I think in the future, Hon. Members who wish to make a point of national interest should liaise with their Chief Whips so that we try and summarise these statements as much as we can, to follow the Standing Rules and Orders. Although, as I said as the Chair, I could indulge if a

matter is of national importance, but it is always good to try and stick to the written-down regulations.

So, I would urge the Members who want to make a point of national interest to always approach their Chief Whips and try and align your statements accordingly.

HON. MATEWU: I rose here three weeks ago on a point of national interest when the fuel prices went up. Basically, I asked for the Minister of Energy and Power Development to come to this august House to give a Ministerial Statement to that effect.

I rose last week on a point of privilege and the Chair said that they would make sure that the Minister comes. Mr. Speaker, this is three weeks now, and it seems to us that the Minister of Energy and Power Development has absolutely disregarded this august House when we expect this House and the people we represent to be notified of the situation as far as fuel is concerned. We demand that the Minister of Energy and Power Development comes to this House as a matter of urgency and give us a Ministerial Statement.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Your point is noted, but I do not think that the Minister of Energy just disregarded coming here. I am sure you are aware that he is one of the ministers who normally come to the House. I am of the understanding that there is some commitment, and he was not around the town, but definitely we will convey that urgency and the message to him so that he comes and delivers that Ministerial Statement.

MOTION

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

HON. TOGAREPI: I move that Orders of the Day, Numbers 1 to 11 on today's *Order Paper* be stood over until Order of the Day Number 12 has been disposed of.

HON. C. MOYO: I second.

Motion put and agreed to.

MOTION

APPROVAL FOR ACCESSION OF THE FUND FOR EXPORT DEVELOPMENT IN AFRICA ESTABLISHMENT AGREEMENT

THE DEPUTY MINISTER OF FINANCE, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND INVESTMENT PROMOTION (HON. K. D. MNANGAGWA): Thank you Mr. Speaker, I move the motion standing in my name that this House-

WHEREAS Section 327 (2) (a) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe provides that any convention, treaty or agreement acceded to, concluded or executed by or under the authority of the President with one or more foreign states or governments or international organizations shall be subject to approval by Parliament.

AND WHEREAS the Fund for Export Development in Africa ("the FEDA") Establishment Agreement entered into force on 1 September 2021, having been signed and ratified by two Afreximbank Member States in terms of paragraph (2) items (i) and (ii) of Article XX.

AND WHEREAS the Republic of Zimbabwe did not sign the FEDA E stablishment Agreement.

AND WHEREAS the Republic of Zimbabwe, having considered the Charters of FEDA Holdco, FEDA Investment Management and

FEDA Capital annexed to the FEDA Establishment Agreement, accepted and acceded to the FEDA Establishment Agreement by depositing an Instrument of Accession dated 10 February 2023,

AND WHEREAS in accordance with paragraph (4) of Article XX of the FEDA Establishment Agreement shall take effect for each contracting Party on the date of deposit of its instrument of ratification, acceptance, approval or accession in accordance with its constitutional or other applicable statutory procedures,

NOW, THEREFORE, in terms of Section 327(2)(a) of the Constitution of Zimbabwe, this House resolves that the FEDA Establishment Agreement be and is hereby approved for accession.

I rise to give a presentation to this august House on the ratification of membership in the Fund for Export Development in Africa (FEDA).

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The Fund for Export Development in Africa (FEDA) is the investment arm of the African Export-Import Bank (AfreximBank). It

was established to provide equity and quasi-equity capital to businesses across Africa, with a particular focus on trade-related investments. Unlike traditional financing (FEDA) is designed to address the chronic shortage of patient capital in Africa by supporting enterprises that drive intra-African trade, value-added exports and industrialisation.

The Fund for Export Development in Africa (FEDA) was established with the overarching goal of addressing Africa's chronic shortage of long-term patient capital and to catalyse sustainable economic growth across the continent. Its objectives are to promote intra-African trade by investing in enterprises that facilitate regional commerce, to support the development of export-oriented industries that enhance Africa's competitiveness in global markets and to drive industrialisation through value addition and manufacturing.

FEDA also seeks to strengthen private sector growth by providing equity and quasi-equity financing to businesses, often underserved by traditional banks, while fostering innovation and resilience in African economies. Ultimately, the Fund aims to diversify sources of growth, reduce dependence on external markets and empower African nations to

fully harness the opportunities presented by the African Continental Free Trade Area.

On 10th February, 2023, Zimbabwe, having considered the Charters of FEDA-Holdco, FEDA Investment Management and FEDA Capital annexed to the FEDA Establishment Agreement, accepted and acceded to the FEDA Establishment Agreement by depositing an Instrument of Accession signed by His Excellency, the President of the Republic of Zimbabwe, Cde. Dr. E. D. Mnangagwa.

Following the depositing of the Instrument of Accession, the Republic of Zimbabwe is required to ratify the FEDA Establishment Agreement in terms of its constitution and relevant statutes and to deposit an Instrument of Ratification in terms of Article 20(4) of the FEDA Establishment Agreement.

Justifications to Ratify FEDA Membership:

1. **Access to Capital:** Zimbabwean enterprises will benefit from equity financing that is otherwise scarce in local and regional markets.

2. **Export Development:** FEDA membership will support the growth of export-oriented industries, enhancing foreign currency earnings.

3. **Industrialisation**: The Fund will catalyse investment in value addition and manufacturing, aligning with Zimbabwe's National Industrialisation Strategy.

4. **Regional Integration:** Participation will deepen Zimbabwe's role in the African Continental Free Trade Area and regional trade development.

5. **Economic Growth:** By unlocking new financial channels, FEDA membership will continue job creation, innovation and sustainable economic growth.

Mr. Speaker, I therefore recommend for the ratification of membership to the Fund for Export Development in Africa in terms of Section 327(2)(a) of the Constitution. I so submit.

HON. DHLIWAYO: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. Good afternoon. For some time, Zimbabwe as a country has faced some major challenges when it comes to accessing international funding and

ratifying the FEDA Establishment Agreement will give us that competitive advantage and access to international financing. You would agree with me that as a country we are in the process of trying to enhance our beneficiation initiatives, our minerals, and that process requires a lot of capital and ratifying the FEDA will give us that opportunity to access funding from the African Export Bank, which is FEDA.

It is important to have access to capital financing to support our exports, which will improve our balance of payments position as a country. Subsequently, that balance of position improvement will also ensure that we settle some of the public debts that we have as an economy. I also think that as a country, if we support or if we ratify this particular position and improve our export growth, that will also mean we earn more foreign currency and our foreign currency reserves improve as a country, which will further strengthen our ZiG.

In addition, by ratifying this agreement, we are also joining several countries that have already signed it. Therefore, that means our regional integration also improves and such integration gives Zimbabwe greater

access to regional and international markets. Such access will not only open international markets but will also boost our economic growth as a country, which is critical in ensuring that the lives of the majority of Zimbabweans improve. I therefore recommend that this House consider and ratify this agreement for the betterment of Zimbabwe. Thank you.

HON. MUSHORIWA: Thank you, Mr. Speaker, for allowing me to present my submission regarding this fund. It is important to note that this fund is a subsidiary of the African Export-Import Bank (Afreximbank). One of our major challenges as a country is our debt overhang, and we are currently facing a debt crisis.

Despite our efforts to rebase our GDP to assess our debt within the context of SADC and in accordance with our national laws, we still owe a significant amount to the African Export-Import Bank. While the introduction of FEDA may seem beneficial, I submit that it may not necessarily bring any tangible advantages to Zimbabwe. Theoretically, we need to be part of every fund, hoping that it will assist us. However, we must first address the root causes of our challenges, particularly the debt hangover that we are experiencing.

When we discuss our debt, we must not focus solely on external debt; we also need to consider the rising domestic debt. By ratifying this FEDA agreement, we may inadvertently increase our debt levels even further. I am unsure why there was a need for us to engage with this subsidiary arm of the bank, especially since we are already minority shareholders as a Government. Additionally, it is crucial to understand what benefits we stand to gain from this agreement. To me, the advantages do not seem to outweigh the disadvantages. We need to seek clarification from the Hon. Minister regarding the specific benefits of this arrangement. The benefits to me do not seem to outweigh the disadvantages. It is even worse given the challenges that we face as an economy. Apart from the debt aspect, there is the question of us as a country ensuring that our economy stabilises. I know that generally, people create an impression that we are out of the woods, but we are not out of the woods, a lot of work needs to be done. What I do not believe and do not know is what the Government is going to do. The Government needs to consult Parliament on what other steps it is going to take to ensure that our debt levels are managed.

It is one thing to be ratifying all these agreements, but at the end of the day, it is costing a lot of money. Mr. Speaker Sir, you are aware that the 2026 budget was passed in December 2025. If you look at the quantum of money that we are allocating for debt servicing, you can combine several ministries' budgets. The Ministry of Women Affairs, the Ministry of Industry and the Ministry of Youth, if you combine the total allocation that we have given to them in this budget, it is far less than the quantum that we have allocated towards debt servicing.

So, my position and my views are that while in principle ratifying these funds is okay, because it has been agreed at a continental level, as a country, I think we need to be careful with these ratifications. Even the agreements themselves, to simply say, have we done the cost-benefit analysis and whether as a country we are benefiting. We do not want a situation where we end up with funds that will charge us exorbitant interest rates, which will tie our future generation in terms of paying those loans.

Secondly, we are also worried about allowing ourselves to be part of a fund that may possibly want to ensure that the minerals that we have

not mined yet are used as collateral. We need to be very careful as a country, because where we are seated at the moment is a very precarious position. We are aware right now as we speak that there is a Government paper in terms of the amount that is owed to local companies that is maturing, to as late as 2042. When we have such a dilemma, you need to be saying to the Government, you signed the agreement, yes, other countries have ratified it, we are going to allow you to ratify the agreement, but you also need to then say to us, in ratifying this agreement, what tangible measures is the Government going to take to ensure that the debt that is upon us as a country, we deal with it. We have been in this high-level debt arrangement or discussion that we are having. You will note that we have not moved an inch as a country in terms of ensuring that we benefit from that. So, this fund…

HON. TOGAREPI: On a point of order Mr. Speaker Sir. I am very worried that the Hon. Member is debating something different from what the Minister has presented. He is talking about the debt of the country and all those things. This fund is not related to that. Why are you bringing everything we know about a different subject? This is a

different subject totally. This is about funding a business. So, he is telling us all what he knows, but not what is in this protocol.

THE ACTING SPEAKER (HON. J. TSHUMA): Thank you Government Chief Whip. Hon. Mushoriwa, did you get that jinx?

HON. MUSHORIWA: No, in fact Chair, I think that the Government Chief Whip needs to take time to read these documents when they are put so that when he raises a point of order, it will be a real point of order. There is a core relationship. This is a fund under the African Import and Export Bank and the Hon. Minister is aware of where I am bringing this. We do not have a problem. This agreement has been ratified by other free countries. In principle, we do not have a problem in terms of having it ratified. What I am raising here are the issues that the Hon. Minister needs to take cognisance of.

We are not like Rwanda or another country; we are Zimbabwe. We have our own unique challenges and one of the unique challenges is the debt. This is the reason why I am raising such fundamental issues, because they have a bearing on this fund. Having said that, my view is that while we are going to ratify this agreement, I think the Executive

arm of Government needs to take broad action in terms of dealing with the debt that is going to threaten us.

Lastly, we are aware that the Reserve Bank, for the past few months, managed to stabilise ZEC. If we are not careful, in the long term, you may find that all the short-term gains that we have had may be eroded, hence our current call to the Minister is to simply say, please do not just sign, but please make sure that in signing this, we also improve on our discipline as a Government. I thank you.

HON. MATEWU: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. I concur with some of the sentiments from the Hon. Member from Dzivarasekwa. However, I think in ratifying this treaty, I do not think it is right for Ministers to come to this House with a short text of a motion to ratify a treaty that we have not seen in agreement. I think in the future, this House needs to be favoured with the agreement.

We need to see the cost-benefit analysis. How much is Zimbabwe paying to this fund? I note that further agreement was established in 2021. We are now in 2026. How much do other countries pay *vis-à-vis* the benefits? So, I think in the future, we need to make sure that Hon.

Members are favoured with the actual agreement so that when we come to this august House, we analyse and debate knowing the paragraphs and the cost implications of such an agreement. We cannot just put a whole country into an agreement without knowing the contents of what we are talking about; only the minister would know. I think in the future, it is prudent that this House be favoured with those agreements so that we come prepared to debate, knowing exactly what is entailed in those agreements. I thank you.

THE TEMPORARY SPEAKER (HON. J. TSHUMA): I think Hon. Matewu, this comes back to what Hon. Mushoriwa was just saying, that it is good to read about these things. These things are there; it just depends on whether you want to pick them.

Right now, Hon. Mushoriwa was making his debate from a position of knowledge because he took his time to read and research on that. So, when we put these things on the *Order Paper*, they are there to help you pick and choose what you want to debate on.

HON. MATEWU: Mr. Speaker, for all the agreements, we now conduct an unpacking workshop for that. The Speaker ruled that for

every single agreement that this country needs to enter into, we hold a workshop and these are normally done on Thursdays, so that Hon. Members are told explicitly on the impacts of these.

However, this was not done; there was no workshop to that effect. This is why I was saying to you we probably need to be enlightened as to the advantages and disadvantages so that we can make an informed position as Hon. Members.

THE TEMPORARY SPEAKER: Thank you and we take note.

HON. TOGAREPI: I want to agree that this protocol is very important to this country. We are doing business with different countries. Our companies run short of funds. They need international finance and support. This fund is not going to give the Government of Zimbabwe cash, nor are we going to borrow from it. This is going to support business as well as allowing the ease of doing business for our country. It is not something that is likely to create debt. If it is going to create debt, it is to the companies. So, that is why I was saying the issue Hon. Mushoriwa was raising was correct in another context that we owe whatever international organisation but this is to facilitate trade.

The Government of Zimbabwe is saying yes, we would want our organisations and companies in Zimbabwe that would need access to these funds to do business to utilise this fund. This is what is being said. I do not see why we should scratch ourselves, talk about our debt but this is not one of them. Yes, we can have those debates another day but for today, we are saying all businesses that are working in Zimbabwe who would want to use the facility as a country, we allow that so that we protect the interest of this institution, not our interest but those who want to do business. This is what this protocol is just saying.

HON. MADZIVANYIKA: Thank you Mr. Speaker. Maybe let me try to unlock this Treaty for the benefit of other Hon. Members who might not have understood it, so that maybe we can be on the same page.

This Treaty relates to the fund for export development in Africa. This fund intends to support local Zimbabwean business who are into export, who are into value addition, who are also part of what we are preparing for the African Continental Free Trade Area. Personally, I do not see any harm in Zimbabwe ratifying this Treaty. This treaty is going to benefit Zimbabwean companies. I do not see anywhere that our

country gets prejudiced. In fact, we benefit as a country. Anything that benefits Zimbabwe has my support.

Let me highlight a few issues. The challenge that we have as Africa, according to statistics from the World Bank, is that we have a $110 billion gap in terms of export funding that we are looking for as Africa to realise our potential in terms of growth potential that we can realise in terms of exports. In that case, Fund for Export Development in Africa (FEDA) is coming in to support that gap. I think that will be good for all of us. Whenever we export more, whenever we get funding to export, we create employment locally. We are not exporting jobs.

We are actually getting foreign currency that we so need to support our local currency and also our foreign reserves.

By and large, I have read the contents of this Treaty. I have not seen something so prejudicial to Zimbabwe and for that matter, therefore, I support this, Mr. Speaker Sir.

THE TEMPORARY SPEAKER: Hon. Members, I think Hon. Madzivanyika has just demonstrated good workmanship in terms of legislation. We encourage and recommend people to read, research, and

be informed. Like what Hon. Madzivanyika said, this is a Treaty that is beneficial to our country and our businesses. So it is not about opposition politics or ruling party politics, but it is about development. Well done, Hon. Madzivanyika.

THE DEPUTY MINISTER OF FINANCE, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND INVESTMENT PROMOTION (HON. D. K. MNANGAGWA):

Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. I would like to thank the Hon. Members for their submissions. I would also like to thank Hon. Madzivanyika for unpacking the true intention of what FEDA is supposed to do.

Zimbabwe is already a shareholder in Afreximbank. This is where we have acquired our sovereign debt. If it were an issue of borrowing from Afreximbank, perhaps the argument from Hon. Mushoriwa would ring true. What the Government is trying to do in ratifying this Treaty is to allow private sector growth. As you would be aware, National Development Strategy 2 is going to be anchored on a very strong private sector-led growth drive. FEDA will open access to equity financing.

You look at your young people in Mvuma, they are right next to a plant that is producing short bars of steel. If they decide that they want to make nuts and bolts but do not have the equity financing to do that, there is now a fund that they can access to raise the capital that will allow them to buy the equipment to be able to have that free enterprise.

Therefore, this is purely an initiative to stimulate private sector growth. I would urge the Hon. Members of this august House to approve the ratification of this Treaty to allow the private sector to access free, long-term equity financing that is beneficial for the whole region.

Motion put and agreed to.

HON. TOGAREPI: I think we have a ministerial statement from the Minister of Health.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Yes, we have a ministerial statement from the Minister of Health, which shall be delivered by the Deputy Minister. You may take the floor.

MINISTERIAL STATEMENTS

STATE OF HOSPITAL INFRASTRUCTURE IN ZIMBABWE

THE DEPUTY MINISTER OF HEALTH AND CHILD CARE (HON. KWIDINI): Thank you Mr. Speaker. I rise to give three ministerial statements, which were requested, from this august House. The first ministerial statement requested was on the state of hospital infrastructure in Zimbabwe. Mr. Speaker, I wish to thank this House for the opportunity to provide an update on the state of hospital infrastructure in Zimbabwe and more importantly, the measures Government is taking to strengthen and modernise our health systems. Recent assessments, including those I conducted, together with the ones undertaken by the Hon. Deputy Minister in Matabeleland North and Matabeleland South, have provided us with an appreciation of conditions on the ground. These visits have been instrumental in informing our priorities and ensuring that our interventions are responsive, targeted and results-oriented.

Mr. Speaker, while these assessments confirm the need to upgrade parts of our infrastructure, Government has already moved decisively from assessment to implementation. Our focus is on practical solutions that improve service delivery, enhance patient safety and create a

conducive work environment for our health personnel. Under the Presidential Hospital Rehabilitation Programme, we are implementing a structured modernisation of central and provincial hospitals. This programme integrates infrastructure refurbishment, equipment upgrades and service delivery improvements to ensure that our major referral institutions meet current healthcare demands. In addition, targeted rehabilitation works are underway across district and provincial hospitals. These include the refurbishment of wards and theatres, roof repairs and the upgrade of water, sanitation and electrical systems. The intention is to restore full functionality and improve the overall patient experience across the country.

Government is also accelerating the completion and operationalisation of new health facilities with priority projects such as Lupane Hospital, which is set to commence services beginning with outpatient and maternity care. This will significantly improve access to healthcare in previously underserved areas. We are strengthening healthcare waste management systems through the rehabilitation and installation of incinerators at district hospitals to ensure safe and

environmentally compliant disposal of medical waste. Recognising the importance of reliable energy, the Ministry has expanded the solarisation programme which over 1 100 yield facilities have already been powered and further expansion is underway. This intervention is improving service continuity, particularly in rural and remote areas.

Government is also prioritising staff accommodation as an integral component of health infrastructure development by improving living conditions for health workers, especially in rural areas, we are enhancing our ability to attract and retain critical skills. At the same time, we are revitalising health training infrastructure through the rehabilitation and reopening of nursing schools at selected district hospitals while also identifying new training sites. This will strengthen our health workforce and support the long-term sustainability of the sector. Hon. Members, our trajectory is clear. We are building a resilient, modern and inclusive health system that delivers quality care to all Zimbabweans. The work underway reflects Government's commitment to sustained investment, strategic partnerships and cooperation and accountable implementation. I thank you Mr. Speaker on this particular ministerial statement.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Thank you very much Honourable Minister. I think you said you had three of them. Is there any intervention on this one?

HON. ENG. MHANGWA: Hon. Speaker, point of clarity. Thank you Mr. Speaker. We have heard the Minister speak of the improvements in general terms and in reality, we have seen more in the tertiary institutions that are national institutions. When is this programme going to come to provincial hospitals, in particular Chinhoyi, Marondera, Bindura, etcetra?

HON. KWIDINI: Thank you Hon. Speaker. What has been raised by the Hon. Member who asked about other specific hospitals is very true. Since we have eight provincial hospitals, we cannot do them all at once but there are some which we have already started to renovate, such as Masvingo Provincial Hospital. Something is underway on that side and if you check even at Chinhoyi, we are working on inside equipment, not outside, but definitely everything is going to be done to make sure that everything is turned into a modern system, which is required by our President. I thank you.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Thank you Hon. Minister. I do not see any further interventions, so you may move to your next ministerial statement.

PROGRESS IN THE UTILISATION OF THE SUGAR TAX BY THE MINISTRY OF HEALTH AND CHILD CARE

THE DEPUTY MINISTER OF HEALTH AND CHILD CARE (HON. KWIDINI): Thank you Mr. Speaker. My next ministerial statement is on progress in the utilisation of the sugar tax by the Ministry of Health and Child Care. Mr. Speaker, I wish to thank the Hon. Member for the question regarding progress on the utilisation of resources mobilised through the sugar tax. I am pleased to report that these funds are being directed towards one of our highest priorities, strengthening cancer diagnosis and treatment capacity in Zimbabwe. Following the release of approximately 30.8 million by the Treasury, the Ministry moved expeditiously to procure critical cancer radiotherapy equipment. Contracts were awarded for the supply of our radiotherapy machines, two low-energy units to be installed at Parirenyatwa Hospital and Mpilo Central Hospital. I am pleased to inform this House that the

procurement process is well underway. Advanced payments have been made to the suppliers in line with the contractual obligations. Two of the radiotherapy machines have already been delivered into the country. Installation works are currently in progress alongside the necessary works to prepare specialised treatment bunkers. Mr. Speaker Sir, this marks a significant milestone in expanding access to the life-saving cancer treatment services, particularly in reducing patient waiting times and the need for referrals outside the country.

With respect to the remaining equipment, deliveries are linked to agreed milestone payments. Treasury has advanced that subsequent payments will be disbursed in phased manner over the coming months. The Ministry is working closely with Treasury and suppliers to ensure that implementation remains on track and that any potential delays are mitigated.

Beyond radiotherapy, Government is liberating the sugar tax as a sustainable financing mechanism to strengthen diagnostic and treatment capacity. Plans are already in place for procurement of additional critical equipment including CT Scanners, mammography units, MIR and other

diagnostic and oncology support technologies. This will significantly enhance early detection, diagnosis and comprehensive cancer management across the country.

The utilisation of sugar tax represents a deliberate and strategic investment in addressing the growing burden of non-communicable diseases, particularly cancer. Our focus is on ensuring that these resources translate into tangible improvements in service delivery, improved patient outcomes and a stronger, more resilient health system. The Ministry remains committed to transparent, accountable and efficient use of these funds in close coordination with the Treasury and other stakeholders. I thank you.

HON. KAPOIKILU: I would like to thank the Hon. Minister for bringing this ministerial statement. When we were requesting the Ministerial Statement, we did not request for what the Hon. Minister presented.

What we said was we want to know how much was collected from inception up to today – [HON. MEMBERS: *Hear, hear.*] - and what that

money was used for. This is what we wanted. Yes, he gave us a figure that by November 2024, we had collected 30.8 million. What did the Ministry buy? Did it buy linear accelerators that eradicate cancer? Did it buy stimulators? If it bought those, how much were they? If they bought those, which type because there are different types of linear accelerators? Prolotherapy machines, did you buy them? Did you buy a UPS system because these machines, you do not just plug them like you plug a TV into the mains or an electric kettle? They are subject to being damaged by surges.

ZESA currents have many surges. If you just plug it in, in five minutes, a machine that you will have bought for $5 million is gone. We want to know what you bought. Did you buy brachytherapy machines as well? – [HON. MEMBERS: *Hear, hear.*] - Did you buy positron tomography machines? What did you buy? This is what we wanted to hear from the Minister. Did you buy diagnostic machines because treating cancer starts with diagnosis? If you cannot diagnose cancer, you cannot conquer.

We are expecting the Minister to tell us if they bought endoscopes. Endoscopy sees inside the body. Are you seeing inside the lung, which is bronchoscopy? Are you seeing inside the oesophagus, in the case of the oesophagus, which is esophagoscope? Are you seeing inside the stomach, which is gastroscopy? Did you buy those machines? This is what we are expecting from the Hon. Minister – [HON. MEMBERS: *Hear, hear.*] -

THE ACTING SPEAKER (HON. J. TSHUMA): Order, order! Let us settle down.

HON. MADZIVANYIKA: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. What I also want from the Hon. Minister, maybe when he comes with a perfected statement, I want to group these machines into categories. The first set is the diagnostic machines, as highlighted by my colleague Hon. Kapoikilu.

How many X-ray machines have been bought and to which districts have they been distributed? How many CT scanners were bought? How many MRI machines were bought? How many ultrasound machines were bought? How many blood analysers were bought? Let us

go to life support. How many ventilators were purchased? Defibrators, dialysis machines, infusion pumps. Which hospitals did they get distributed?

Then we have the fundamental one, the patient care equipment, wheelchairs. You get to the hospital and you are told that there is no wheelchair, so please wait. They have only one wheelchair. That is so embarrassing, Hon. Minister. How many stretchers were acquired? Lastly, the hospital bed. We have seen patients sitting on the floor. It is not a good sign, actually. We want a clear statement, that elaborates on what was bought, and to which hospitals were those items distributed. I thank you.

HON. MUSHORIWA. Mr. Speaker, if you listen to Hon. Kapoikilu, it is clear that the Ministerial Statement that the Hon. Minister has brought to this august House is not sufficient and the Minister when he was reading, he did not say a Ministerial Statement - he said, he responded as if he was responding to a question. A Ministerial Statement by nature is supposed to be full-fledged, detailed with information.

There is a waste part of the Ministerial Statement, Mr. Speaker Sir. The Minister then advises us, Parliament, the representative of the people, that the Ministry of Health and Child Care received 30 million in 2024. He does not talk anything about 2025. Yet, sugar tax is being collected literally on a daily basis.

My view, Mr. Speaker, is that if it is possible, the Hon. Minister needed to go back and prepare a proper Ministerial Statement to answer all the taxes and all the issues that the Hon. Member has raised. What he has done, the Hon. Minister has answered the question in a narrow angle. When in fact, a Ministerial Statement is supposed to be broad. We cannot say a Ministerial Statement is calm. We just need to talk about 2025; the sugar taxes that we actually collected. The whole year, nothing. He talks about 2024. It does not make sense, Mr. Speaker Sir.

So, I humbly ask that the Hon. Minister of Health goes back if possible. Come back with a proper, detailed Ministerial Statement. So that we as Hon. Members of Parliament, can then interrogate it further. Thank you. – [HON. MEMBERS: *Hear, hear.*] -

HON. TOGAREPI: Thank you Mr. Speaker. I would also want to hear more about what we raised. I am happy that we raised $30 million. Surely, $30 million has items that we bought. I do not see any harm, Minister, that you itemise those things and bring them here – [HON. MEMBERS: *Hear, hear.*] –

If you have renovated a block at Harare Hospital, mention the name of the block, we applied so much. At Masvingo, we applied so much. The equipment, what is it? We itemised because Hon. Members here, including the people of Zimbabwe, would want to know- it is an important text because it goes to the core of non-communicable diseases. There is a problem in this country. We want to see the strides the Government has managed to make, faced with the outbreaks. Also, now that we have something to mitigate those challenges, what have you done? So, a list of those will make us all comfortable, Minister. Thank you.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: I think I am persuaded to agree with Hon. Mushoriwa and Hon. Togarepi Yes, of course, he was the author of everything but instead of the Deputy Minister responding to this

Ministerial Statement, he will rather go and come back to the House with a fully-fledged statement, detailing how the money has been used because the House needs to get the full first-hand information on the expenditure of the money that we raised on that sugar tax. Hon. Members will agree that a matter of health is a matter of concern to everybody. Anybody is a candidate for any of these diseases. So, it is very important that you go back and come up with a fully-fledged Ministerial Statement.

HON. ENG. MHANGWA: On a point of order Mr. Speaker. Taking from the ruling that you made on the second Ministerial Statement, it is also prudent that the first one, we have heard him talk of Masvingo and Chinhoyi but there are no details to accompany that. Therefore, it means that both fall under the same query. I so submit.

THE ACTING SPEAKER I will grant that wish as well because it is also important. Hon. Minister, even the first one, can you go back and detail it. – [HON. MEMBERS: *Inaudible interjections.*] -Order, order! We are not going to take any of these things lightly because this is a matter of national interest; it is a matter of health. Please come back

with the first one as well. – [HON. MEMBERS: *Inaudible interjections.*] -Order, order Hon. Members. If it is not detailed Hon. Minister, I think you would rather ask for a deferment and get it detailed because we want detailed responses. When it comes to health, we are not going to beat about the bush; we want to be accountable to the nation of Zimbabwe.

HON. KWIDINI: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. I would like to ask for a deferment for this so that we bring all nitty-gritties they want in a big dossier to show what was said by Hon. Members and Hon. Kapoikilu to assist him to know what we have done as a Ministry and where we have placed it and what the cost. So, that the whole House will be furnished with this information.

HON. CHIGUMBU: On a point of order Mr. Speaker. I am asking whether the Hon. Deputy Minister can liaise with Dr. Kapoikilu so that when he comes back, he does not miss important aspects. I think they must cooperate. He is the shadow minister here; I think he can assist him. Thank you.

THE ACTING SPEAKER Hon. Chigumbu, for your own information, all Hon. Members here have access to any Minister. If Hon. Kapoikilu has issues that need to be brought to the attention of the Minister, he is always free to approach the Minister, even at their offices. I am sure the Minister is always willing to receive Hon. Members. Thank you.

***HON. TOBAIWA:** Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. I am requesting that when the Hon. Minister comes, I heard people saying we have a balance of about three months for the ARVs which are worth six months. I think it is also wise to notify this House of the position of this medication.

THE ACTING SPEAKER: Hon. Minister, could you please include the state of the medication that was spoken about? Include that in your written submissions when you come back. Thank you.

HON. KWIDINI: Thank you Hon. Speaker. I think I brought all the answers for the raised Ministerial Statement but since we have seen the formula, they want us to present it, which is why I asked for a deferment. I will come with the formula they want so that what we are

saying and what we have at the present moment on the issue of medicine availability, we have it. Thank you.

MOTION

BUSINESS OF THE HOUSE

HON. TOGAREPI: I move that Orders of the Day, Numbers 1 to 3 be stood over until Order of the Day Number 4 has been disposed of.

HON. C. MOYO: I second.

Motion put and agreed to.

SECOND READING

CLIMATE CHANGE MANAGEMENT BILL [H. B. 5, 2025].

Fourth Order read: Adjourned debate on the Second Reading of the Climate Change Management Bill [H. B. 5, 2025].

Question again proposed.

HON. MUROMBEDZI: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir for allowing me to add my voice to this debate. Climate change is not a distant stone. It is the flood that we see in Chimanimani, which sweeps away our schools in Chipinge, the heatwave that scotches our communities in Hwange, one silent drought that empties our granaries in Mhondoro.

This Bill before us is not merely about emissions but, it is about justice, survival and the dignity of our people. If we pass it in its current form, we risk legislating half measures, if we sharpen it, we can legislate hope.

People have spoken with one voice and have guaranteed 40% community share in carbon projects. This is not merely charity but it is justice, without it, the carbon markets that we seek to have in this country become another extractive industry where profits flow upward and poverty remains downwards.

Mr. Speaker, with it, we transform climate projects that we seek to have as engines of rural empowerment. We need to legislate it, prior and informed consent, not as a slogan but as a shield against land grabbing and elite capture.

I want to move on to the green buildings and the built environment. Buildings account for 39% of global emissions. Every brick we lay out, foresight as a brick in the war of climate disaster. The stakeholders who were consulted demanded a national green building code, a certification mandate and rating systems.

Mr. Speaker, this is the foresight that we are looking for. If we legislate green building standards, we align Zimbabwe with global best practices and reduce our carbon footprint, as well as create jobs in sustainable construction. We must not build monuments to yesterday's ignorance but build foundations for tomorrow's resilience.

Moving on to ministerial powers and governance, which are in the Bill. The Bill seeks to centralise too much power in one ministry. Appeals against but mental decisions cannot return to the same minister. Hon. Speaker, that is justice denied. We need an independent tribunal to review disputes impartially. Climate governance, Mr. Speaker, must be subject to the rule of law, not ministerial whim, otherwise we risk turning climate policy into a political fiefdom rather than a national covenant.

Let me move on to physical accountability and the climate fund. The national climate fund is a noble idea, Hon. Speaker but it needs strict oversight. It risks becoming another off-budget/fund. Treasury or another independent board must chair it with quarterly public reporting. Rural District Councils must receive 50% of the funds to finance local

climate operations. If we fail to legislate this transparent, we betray the trust of the people. Climate finance must not vanish into corridors in Harare; it must flow to the ward level where resilience is built.

I want to move on to health and vulnerability, which is in the Bill also. Mr. Speaker Sir, climate change is not only about carbon, it is about the lives and the livelihoods of the people. Floods bring cholera, heatwaves bring malaria and droughts bring hunger. Stakeholders demanded mandatory early warning systems integrated with health services. We need to legislate the climate health core benefits so that every intervention, whether solar farms or reforestation, also strengthens our hospitals, protects our children and saves lives.

On to the international alignment - Zimbabwe must play on the international stage. Without credible measurement, reporting and verification MRV, our carbon credits will be rejected. Aligning definitions with IPCC standards cannot be optional; it is essential for accessing the climate finance. If we legislate out of data systems, we prevent double-counting and ensure our carbon markets are competitive. Climate justice at home must be matched by credibility abroad.

In conclusion, women and climate vulnerability Climate gender is not gender neutral; it strikes hardest at those already carrying the heaviest burdens. In Zimbabwe, that burden falls disproportionately on women. When droughts deepened, it is women who walk longer distances in search of food, firewood and water.

Therefore, Hon. Speaker, I would like to support the Committee's report and do hope that we take into consideration what we have debated here so that we come up with a Bill that is pro-people. I so submit.

HON. MAKOPE: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir, for giving me this opportunity to add my voice on the Climate Change Management Bill [H. B. 5. 2025]. I want to start by applauding our esteemed Government, His Excellency, The President, Dr. E. D. Mnangagwa, for coming up with this noble policy framework that I believe will speak largely on the climate issues. It has come during a time when we are in an environmental consciousness, people are talking much about the environment since climate issues affect our day-to-day activities.

The Bill touches on the causes of climate change and it also touches on the consequences of climate change. I think this Bill has

come at the right time to assist in the resilience, adaptation as well as mitigation of the challenges of climate change. I can also applaud our Government because at the moment, Zimbabwe is at the forefront of crafting a policy that will assist all Zimbabweans. Very soon, we are going to see a stampede of other nations coming for, look and learn because so far, Zimbabwe is the sole African nation that is addressing climate issues through a policy framework.

I also want to applaud this Bill, because it recognises other conventions and treaties that we have signed and domesticated as a nation. So, it is very important, to consider several issues that have been coming and working in silos, so they are now compressed into this Bill. Therefore, we believe it is going to address those issues that we are facing. Zimbabwe has approved for ratification most significant conventions, protocols and treaties relating to environmental management and climate change such as the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change. The Paris Agreement, the Cutaways Rulebook, the Kyoto Protocol of 6 April 2007, the Convention on Biological Diversity and the United Nations Convention to Combat

Desertification, more so, the Ramsar Convention on Wetlands, the one that we are chairing on 13 May 2015. So, taking into consideration the contents of all these conventions and treaties, it means the Bill is addressing the real issues Zimbabwe is facing.

There is a very important aspect of carbon trading, the carbon marketing which is being addressed in this Bill. The Climate Change Bill before us proposes carbon trading which comes with a carbon trading digital platform framework that is a transformative world-class system that enhances transparency, efficiency and credibility. In carbon markets through advanced digital technologies, it streamlines the entire carbon credit life cycle, reducing costs and bureaucracy that has been taking place in the carbon trading. The issue of carbon trading has been taking place without the knowledge of the authorities.

We have these projects, which have been taking place, for example, we can talk of the carbon projects such as the Kariba, the Chirisa, Gonarezhou but all those activities were done without the knowledge of the Government. So, eventually we ended up having lack of a strong national regulatory framework, even revenue leakages

because the deals were just done between the project implementers and probably the locals. The weak benefit-sharing models, our locals have not been benefiting much from the carbon trading. There is also limited transparency, accountability and minimum Government oversight. So, all these issues are being addressed in the Bill, and I think the Bill is in the right direction.

Again, Mr Speaker, when we are looking at the carbon credits, let me just touch on the community sharing issues. In most cases, most of our people were getting *tsotso* stoves or bicycles after their negotiations with these project implementers. The bulk of the money has been repatriated back to their countries, particularly those from the global north. So, by having this policy framework, I believe our people are going to benefit. I just want to stress that the Minister has to make sure that the villagers, the communities, should also have easy access to registration of their own projects because they are the ones who own these forests, they own these wetlands and other environmental resources around which might be used in the carbon credit trading. So, they should be able to register their own companies. Even if we allow

those who come from other nations to participate or to register those large projects in our country, our people should also benefit in one way or the other because we should have transparency in the registration of these projects, proper consultations with the communities. At the end of the day, they will be participating and benefiting much from the process of these carbon credits.

I think the Minister has to make sure that even the Statutory Instruments are issued regularly to guide in this benefit sharing aspect and also regulate some of the issues but making sure that the community is benefiting. This is one of the things that His Excellency the President made sure that our people are empowered through their natural resources because we own them. We are the owners of those resources. Unlike the environmental impact assessment in the past, some people have been circumventing through other processes and we ended up having some of the projects being implemented even though they might not qualify the checklists or the standards which we expect to see a project being implemented but because the issue of carbon credits has been done without the knowledge of the Government, such things will happen.

Let me just comment on the issue of the fund, which is also very important. I think this fund is going to assist largely with some of the disasters. We have the Civil Protection Unit in our districts which has been looking for some funds to assist those people who might be affected by disasters such as cyclones. I believe with such a fund, if it is channelled towards that, the people from the villages will end up benefiting largely from this fund. Again, I think the policy framework should also address the issue of the codes and certification of the standards of the buildings which we should construct, even at the village level. The severity of most of these disasters, which we face as a developing nation, like the cyclones, they were so severe largely because the material, sometimes, which we use to construct our structures, has been so poor and substandard that it cannot resist the shock of the disasters. So, I think our local authorities, leveraging from this policy framework, should also have the standards or the codes that stipulate the expectations of the materials used to construct a standard house or a hut which is adaptable to the community dwellers. I think with this framework, we can be guided towards that. I would like to present an

example of a church that remained intact after Cyclone Idai in the Eastern Highlands. This resilience can be attributed to the fact that the church was constructed using very strong materials and adhered to specific building standards. It is important to emphasise that its survival was not due to the intensity of the prayers offered by the congregation but rather the durability of the materials used in its construction.

I believe that if we can supervise the structures we construct in our villages, it will greatly assist us, just as we have been doing in urban areas. I am also very pleased to see the establishment of a department specifically dedicated to addressing climate change issues within the ministry. If this department is guided effectively by the Minister, it will play a crucial role in the adaptation to and mitigation of climate shocks.

However, it is essential to ensure that the operationalisation of this department is effective. The Minister must prioritise education, specifically, proper education, to inform our communities about how this policy framework operates. Furthermore, we need to support the officers on the ground, equipping them with the knowledge and tools they need to help prevent and adapt to climate-related challenges.

These are some of my comments on this very important Bill, which has come at a crucial time as Zimbabwe, like many other nations, faces the challenges of climate change. The impacts of climate change affect nearly everyone in our country. As the Government of Zimbabwe, I would like to commend our administration for its efforts in streamlining climate issues. The Government has ensured that all ministries are addressing these challenges and that their budgets reflect the necessary funding to tackle climate-related concerns. With these remarks, I submit.

HON. MAVHUDZI: Thank you Hon. Speaker for this wonderful opportunity to also add my voice on this one. I rise to contribute to the Climate Change Bill. This Bill comes at an opportune time because climate change has become an existential threat to the Zimbabwean way of life. Therefore, I want to applaud the Ministry for bringing this Bill forward. However, I must emphasise that, while the intention behind this legislation is commendable, we need to be thorough in its creation to avoid any unintended consequences. We must approach this matter with diligence and care.

Whilst I support the Bill, I just want to take necessary care in addressing a few issues. The first issue that Parliament should address is the issue of centralising power around the Minister. The current draft over-concentrates power around the Minister who sits at the centre of all regulatory, financial and policy decisions. In this fashion, the climate change law risks becoming subject to the whims of a single office rather than the stability of an institution. Is it not possible for us to follow the example of our regional peers like Kenya and South Africa, who have independent climate councils which are structured in a way that distributes authority around experts, civil society and multiple ministries?

The second issue that I also want us to take note of is accountability in the National Climate Fund. The Fund is a very noble idea and the establishment of the same by this Bill is very critical. However, notwithstanding the importance of the Fund, we need to be careful of placing the Fund solely under the purview of the Ministry without proper parliamentary and public oversight mechanisms and frameworks. Is it not possible for the Fund to be governed by an

independent board with mandatory reporting to Parliament? Public trust is very necessary when it comes to the Fund.

My third and probably the last point is on the issue of carbon trading. The introduction of carbon trading is very important and innovative but in its current form, there is a risk of having a pay to pollute scheme. It risks allowing worthy entities and big corporations to pollute and simply buy their way out of environmental responsibility without reducing their actual footprint. If we continue on that trajectory, we will be trading our future for sure. We must pay for carbon trading with binding emission limits.

The market has a responsibility of incentivising the reduction of carbon emissions instead of buying their way through. In hindsight, I support the Bill but I feel we need to take care of these few items to make sure that our law becomes congruent and comprehensive so that it addresses the issue, the malady of climate change. I submit.

HON. HAMAUSWA: I would like to begin by stating that this Bill comes at a crucial time when Zimbabwe, like many other countries, particularly in the southern part of Africa, is experiencing the negative

effects of climate change. Our nation has faced droughts, severe flooding, and challenges to food security, all of which are exacerbated by extreme temperatures and related diseases. Just this week, we witnessed heavy rains during a period when we expected our farmers to be harvesting. These are clear signs of climate change, indicating that our agricultural systems are being adversely affected. Thus, this Bill is timely and necessary as we seek to address these pressing challenges in Parliament.

However, I concur with my colleagues who have expressed that there is a need to give thorough attention to this Bill. This is a very ambitious Bill, but the area we are legislating is very complicated. There is really a need for the Minister to take heed of the recommendations that were gathered by the Committee. Recommendations from experts in climate change are that even when you check in our universities, there are limited degrees that are being offered in terms of climate change and even the negotiations at the international level. Our people are not well-equipped to negotiate at the international level.

So, there is a need for more research and funding so that at the end of the day, we come up with a comprehensive Bill that will address many issues. Climate change affects almost all sectors of our economy. This is why one of the major objectives of this Bill seeks to provide a national climate change response through the mainstreaming of climate change across all sectors of the economy. It includes, among other things…

THE ACTING SPEAKER: May all other Hon. Members who are not on the floor, please take their seats. Only the Member who has been asked to take the floor must be standing at any given time. It is a basic rule and housekeepers, please limit the number of people who come to your desk.

HON. HAMAUSWA: Thank you Mr. Speaker Sir. I was saying that climate change affects all sectors of our economy. It affects everyone. As a result, one of the major objectives of this Bill is to provide a national climate change response through the mainstreaming of climate change across all sectors of the economy, maybe through other things coming up with measures of adaptation and mitigation. You

will find that even in the Bill, there is a clear line or thread that shows that there is going to be inter-ministerial relationships, the Liaison Committees that will work across ministries.

So, I propose that there is also a need to rethink how the Inter-Ministerial and Liaison Committees are going to work without causing conflicts within and across the ministries.

There is a relationship between the Ministry of Environment and local authorities. There is a need to fine-tune the way and the manner in which climate change and the ministry work with local and urban authorities.

I also agree that in terms of the built environment, buildings, studies have shown that they contribute up to 39% of global emissions. However, within our context, I propose that we need to do an evaluation and analysis of where our traditional buildings, where we use teaching, are part of this 39%. How can we embrace the heritage that we have and the systems that we use, because if you look at teaching and even other methods, how are we going to use our heritage? Are we going to be

bunched together with other building materials that cause these emissions? We need to be very careful to check where we stand.

There is an effort to make sure that we promote development that will reduce carbon emissions. We need to understand that we are still a developing country and we have vast mineral resources. How are we going to adapt or adopt technologies that will allow us to meet the requirements of this Bill, but without also disadvantaging us from getting a value out of our coal, gas and other mineral resources?

Mr. Speaker Sir, I also want to comment on the establishment of the Climate Management Board. I propose that there is no need for duplication. It would be better if the ministry or the Bill proposed to strengthen the Environmental Management Agency (EMA). EMA, if you check even on the reports by the Portfolio Committee, the report says that the stakeholders were arguing that the ministry should make use of EMA officers who are located in all ten provinces.

So, in my view, strengthening the Environmental Management Board, the authority and taking these other functions, even renaming it to take the approach to deal with climate change issues, I think it will do

a good job without creating too many boards that will require significant funding. Our country does not have the luxury of having too many boards because they will need more funding.

However, as we all know, EMA is all over. What is needed is to make sure that they are given the necessary powers. The Bill says this is going to take precedence over all other laws when it comes to the environment and climate change. Therefore, it means that it is going to disable EMA instead of strengthening it and streamlining those provisions even if it takes to amend the EMA Act. Let it be and let us strengthen EMA.

We know Mr. Speaker Sir, we have had reports in our country whereby EMA officers would issue reports but, they could not stop some mining activities that were not friendly to the environment. I represent a constituency where there has been mining of gravel since the 9th Parliament. I tried using this Parliament to fight for responsible extraction of gravel in Warren Park but we failed, not because we do not have the ideas. We do have the ideas but we did not have the necessary

power. If there were necessary powers, I tell you, we could have stopped the irresponsible extraction of gravel in Warren Park.

If we are going to have this Bill, we are not giving the necessary powers to make sure that they guide the development in our country; we are not going to achieve the necessary objectives enshrined in this Bill. So, we need to make sure that there is political will. We do not want to continue experiencing political interference where there is a need for environmental assessment. It has to be done, not a situation that we read in the reports and newspapers that, for example Long Chen, Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) was done well, but after the construction of that mall, it is sad because we see the depletion of our wetlands which are important in protecting the environment and in terms of limiting the emissions of gases.

So, I really plead with this House to make sure that when we pass this Bill and many other Bills, we give the necessary teeth to our laws. Implementation has been a problem in our country and we continue to cry because there is no political will.

If you check what is happening in Boterekwa, you will cry, our mountains are going, but we are not getting the necessary returns. So, I also applaud the Bill for the proposal that there will be some community share ownership. This concept has been around since 1980. I do not know whether it is within the Cabinet or the Executive where there is this concept that the poor must not become part of the middle class. Yet we say, as we move towards 2030, we want to see the middle class growing. How is it going to grow? We just call community share ownership 40%, but do we have the necessary structures? How far have we learned from the disbanded community share ownership schemes that were there, that were established in the mining areas? Are we going to see a difference?

So, when we are coming up with this Bill, I would encourage the Hon. Members, who come from areas where there are mining activities, to look at what stood in the way of a successful implementation of community share ownership schemes in Ngezi, Mhondoro-Ngezi, in Zvishavane and areas like when you go to Chiyadzwa. What was the challenge? So, what are the new aspects that will make sure the

community share ownership schemes succeed? There is also a proposal from the stakeholders that there is a need for training the local people. Our people need to be trained. They cannot understand concepts like carbon credits. There are too many technical. We need to break them down using the language they can understand. We need to make sure that when we talk of carbon credits, we can link up with all other projects?

When we do village business units, how do we link them with carbon credits? I think we have a long way to go in this Bill. We need to make sure that if possible, as Parliament, we will see all clauses, such that when we pass this Bill, we will all be happy and it will be clear that even when we pass on the batons to other people to lead. We will also be sure that our nation will be safe. At the moment, I am worried that if Hon. Mapiki is going to pass a baton in 2028 to other people, will they be safe that our environment will be protected? So we need to make sure that we refine this Bill. There is also a need to ensure that the funds proposed by the Bill we put the necessary measures that the fund be

accessible to those who are supposed to access it and to limit the minister's powers.

I also suggest that the minister will give strategic direction, but if we open the floodgates so that the minister can also have access to the fund, it will be problematic. We had problems with ZIMDEF. Our memories are still fresh and we cannot pass another Bill where we know we can also experience the situation we experienced with ZIMDEF.

Therefore, we need to come up with something; we do not hate the minister, because this is not about an individual. We are creating laws for posterity, so we are not creating laws targeting an individual. We are just saying in the future, you never know, maybe tomorrow I will be the minister. I do not want to be involved in the direct management of this fund. So, I would suggest the fund can be managed by the Environmental Management Agency (EMA). I think EMA has the requisite experience. We have to strengthen EMA, give her the funds, then the minister will give strategic direction to the fund. If we do that, I am sure we are going to be happy.

The other thing that I also want to talk about is the reporting of five years, that is proposed the view on what is happening with climate change issues. I propose a one-year reporting cycle for this period, when we are just starting. Maybe we can say for the first five years, the reporting should be one year, because what we are doing is we are going through uncharted waters. We are going through a road that we have never walked on. Maybe the road has been walked by other countries, but we are still learning.

As we are saying, the Bill needs more refining, data collection and data analysis of climate change issues and activities. We are not all aware of how this is going to be done. We cannot wait five years to get a report. Last time we were talking about our bridges, they are going down. But for today, Madam Speaker, for us to say that they will report after five years when we have not adapted construction systems that are in line with the green economy. We have not started promoting the green economy. So, we still have a long way to go.

So, I think one year, the Committee proposed two years, but I would go for one year. Yearly reports I think, will make sure that even

the minister will not sleep. There is a lot of money in this area, the green economy, so I want to conclude that there is a lot that we can say. I think I have said enough for now. I wish that this House would take it seriously. Those who have not also decided to debate on this Bill, I am sure they should develop an interest because it will affect us in the way we breathe. It will affect us on what we eat. It will affect everything. It will affect us in many ways and we cannot just ignore this Bill to go through without putting a critical assessment on each clause. I thank you.

***HON. MAPIKI:** Thank you Madam Speaker. I want to support the Bill that is before us. I want to add a few things to this Bill. What made me happy is that they want to come up with a Liaison Committee, which will oversee the running of the committee. We once had a Committee on CAMPFIRE, thinking that the money would be directed to the committees but it was directed to the councils. Now that money ended up paying for salaries. So, the Liaison Committee should be empowered so that it can have a say. In the end, they will end up rubber-stamping things. So the liaison committee should be strong and it should

be given a roadmap. The other issue that has been talked about in the Bill, Minister, I was thinking that the Bills that we are coming up with should improve our economy so that we do not rely on foreigners to fund us, surely we will end up going all over. So, I think we should look at that closely.

When it comes to reporting, I think the reporting time should be lessened and each and every year we should get a report so that we know what is going on and if there are things that need to be rectified, then they can be rectified on time. Looking at the committees in the rural areas, we should make sure that they are comprised of people who stay in those areas. If someone from Mashonaland Central goes and is incorporated in a Committee in Binga, it means that the Committee will not function well because that person will not be conversant with the language. Looking at the projects that people are engaging in, we should not just look at chicken rearing as these are small projects. We should look at our projects in terms of the area. For example, in Tsholotsho and Hwange, where there are game parks, we cannot force them to do

horticulture because there is no water. We should encourage them to engage in tourism.

If we go to Gonarezhou and Chikwalakwala, we should look at what really benefits the people in that area, depending on the terrain. So, I think that when we are rolling out these projects, we should make sure that the local people are empowered and they have a voice. We engaged in campfires but it did not go very well.

Coming to climate change officers, we should have people who are knowledgeable in climate change, but first preference should be given to the locals to avoid taking people from other areas. For example, if I come from Binga and when we are talking of people who should work in those areas, I think they should come from the local community because those other people will not be aware of the language and culture of the people there. So that should really be looked at.

Our plea Hon. Minister, is that 98% funding for that Bill should be from Zimbabwe. Foreign funding is hampering our progress and is coming with stringent measures and conditions. So, when we are talking about carbon taxes, we are given conditions which we want to avoid.

With your indulgence, Madam Speaker, Hon. Hamauswa said in 2028 we are going for elections, so I just want to correct him that we agreed that we are going for elections in 2030. Thank you Madam Speaker.

HON. MUSHORIWA: Thank you Madam Speaker. I have a few issues that I feel I need the Hon. Minister to help us with. The first issue that I needed to raise is the structuring of this Bill. I am not so sure because the manner in which this Bill is structured is that we are talking about the Department of Climate Change within the Ministry. If you read it properly, you see that there is some confusion within the Bill in respect to whether or not the Department would actually be a stand-alone Department or an Authority. If you read through it, you get an impression that a Director of the Climate Change Management is supposed to be a Director within the Ministry. In terms of the Government bureaucracy, he is supposed to report to someone like the Permanent Secretary. If you read this Bill, you hardly get any role for the Permanent Secretary. There is only one mention which I will be

coming to in my second point. The question of this department, and I am also not so sure Madam Speaker, why the Ministry or the drafters of this Bill decide to include some operational issues within this Bill, which I believe will be part of this Bill. For instance, if you look at the various departments that we have mentioned in this Bill, they have to be led by the Deputy Director, they have to go through this and that. I actually think that this information should probably not be in the Bill, *per se*, because of the dynamics in managing ministry changes. One day, you want the Director of Climate Change Management to be a Chief Director, for instance, or you need the units to be led by a director.

You do not necessarily need to come to Parliament to have those amendments because those things should actually be within the operational aspect of Government and I am not so sure why we included all these details in the Bill. I actually thought that some of these things, in their day-to-day operations, there are changes that can happen within the Government or the Public Service Commission will probably do some job evaluation and other stuff.

So, including it in the Bill, I find it tricky. Then there is an issue, which I think the Hon. Minister needs to help us. It is about the fund.

According to this Bill, the Minister is going to be the trustee of the Fund. It then says that the fund will be administered on behalf of the Minister, by the accounting officer of the Minister responsible for climate change. What this means is that we have a fund, which is likely to receive a huge chunk of money that will come from the levies payable in terms of carbon trading, carbon tax, national ozone unit. The Minister wants us to believe that this Fund will be managed by one person, by the accounting officer. I cannot understand how you can have a Fund.

Look at all the funds that we have in Government. You cannot have a fund that is managed by one person, more so given the lucrative nature of this Fund - you cannot. You need to make sure that there are mechanisms, balance sheets, and we need the Hon. Minister to help us to understand the rationale why we are actually moving away from an established fund management system that we have always used in the country.

So, these, Madam Speaker, are important issues that I think need to be framed. I am not going to dwell much on other issues, because other Hon. Members have actually made good on the various issues, which I also will be waiting to hear the response from the Hon. Minister for further engagement when we then come to the Committee Stage but I felt, Madam Speaker, that three critical issues, the question of this department, you cannot have a department that is within the Ministry, is given certain powers, even some units, they are allowed to do certain things. I do not understand how that will work in a proper ministry.

Normally, in a ministry, when you write letters, there is a standard procedure to say all letters should go to the Permanent Secretary as the Accounting Officer of the ministry. The Permanent Secretary will remain answerable to the performance of the ministry as a whole.

Those are my issues, Madam Speaker, and we will be grateful to hear the response from the Hon. Minister so that at least we will be able to understand how we can then interact with her when we come to the Committee Stage. Thank you.

HON. MASVINGISE: Good afternoon, Madam Speaker. I rise to support the Climate Change Management Bill, a piece of legislation that represents a historic opportunity to align our national development with the principles of social justice, constitutional integrity, and environmental accountability. This Bill is not merely an administrative framework; it is a shield for the vulnerable, and a tool for empowering every citizen to become a guardian of our national heritage.

Madam Speaker Ma'am, I will zero in on Clause 3. My support for Clause 3 is rooted in the understanding that climate management requires a holistic mandate rather than narrow departmental enforcement. Central to this is the explicit requirement for free, prior, and informed consent (FPIC). This provision is vital because it empowers our communities, particularly those most vulnerable, with the legal authority to give or to withhold consent on projects on their ancestral lands.

I will amplify this part, Madam Speaker Ma'am. The Second Republic championed an approach which is the Whole-of-Society Participatory Approach (WOSPA), where it ensures that there is the

strengthening and participation and the consent from the stakeholders out there, let us say in Gumbonzvanda, in Tshepiri, in Gutu East or even from Hon. Hamauswa's constituency. So, this Bill is actually addressing the issues.

By mandating FPIC, we ensure that development is never synonymous with displacement or exploitation, but is instead a collaborative partnership that respects the agents of local people. In my view, Madam Speaker Ma'am, Clause 5 of the Bill serves as the moral compass of this Bill, enshrining the philosophy of leaving no one and no place behind. To truly reflect our national values, we must update our legislative language to be inclusive of youths and persons with disabilities, moving away from outdated and exclusionary technology.

Furthermore, we must ensure that Clause 5.2, a proviso D, strikes a delicate balance between industrial development and the protection of climate rights as enshrined in our Constitution, particularly Section 73 of the Constitution. Crucially, this Bill must grant every citizen and resident the legal standing to stop activities that cause environmental damage. We have seen the necessity of such legal empowerment in

recent years through the intervention of our courts, and I will cite a few examples;

The Chitungwiza Municipality is a water and sewage case. In 2020, the High Court was forced to order the Council to stop discharging raw sewage into water sources and to repair systems within three months to prevent environmental pollution.

A second citation would be the Chitungwiza down-site safety case, again in 2020. The High Court had to step in to order the fencing of a 'killer' dump site and cessation of operation until certified by the Environmental Management Agency (EMA) to protect child safety. The third citation is the Harare City Council Sewerage Case of 2025. The High Court directed the city to repair sewerage bursts in areas such as Kambuzuma, Budiriro, Glenview and Rugare following the legal action by EMA.

Madam Speaker Ma'am, the Bill recognises that for laws to be effective, there must be a shift from corporate anonymity to personal accountability. I strongly support the inclusion of provisions that hold the leadership of corporate bodies and partnerships directly responsible

for environmental crimes. So, the piercing of this corporate veil is now a shield and I do want to buttress the point that the worries that Hon. Hamauswa has already alluded to are catered for in this Bill in that the Bill is pushing for the piercing of corporate veil because I think most of the directors were hiding behind the limited liability. Now, this Bill is pushing for piecing of that drain.

Under this Bill, where a board corporate or partnership commits an offence, every director, partner or officer who had knowledge of the violation and failed to exercise due diligence and efficiency to ensure compliance shall be held personally liable. I think an era of even being in contempt of court orders could be an issue of the past once this has been assented to. We are sending a clear message that environmental negligence will no longer be hidden in a corporate veil. Those in positions of power who knowingly oversee the destruction of our climate will face the full force of law, including fines of level 14, imprisonment of up to five years or both. This ensures the polluter pays principle beyond a company's balance sheet to the very individual making the decision.

Finally, to ensure these mandates are effectively executed, we must look at the structure of the Climate Change Management Department, under Clause 7. To avoid the Ministry silos that often paralyse Government action, I support establishing the department as a semi-autonomous body. Such a structure would allow seamless coordination across the vital sectors of energy, agriculture, mines and finance. Let me zero in on this aspect as well. If we were to look at another approach that is being championed by the Second Republic, where we look at the whole of Government approach, it ensures we are breaking down the silos. So, Clause 7 really deals with this aspect and I think we should commend the drafters for pushing this. Surely, I would believe Hon. Hamauswa, as we move on, you would be in support of that clause too. This empowered department would not only maintain a national registry for green building certification but would also possess the authority to enforce climate risk assessments for all major infrastructure projects. By supporting these provisions, we are creating a governance system that is transparent, inclusive and legally robust. We are ensuring that the spirit of our Constitution is felt in every ward and village and that our path to a

green economy is packed with justice for all Zimbabweans. I humbly submit.

HON. MATSUNGA: Thank you Mr. Speaker, for allowing me to add my voice to the Climate Change Bill. I rise in support of the Climate Change Management Bill, a legislative milestone that promises to anchor our national development in sustainability and economic justice. This Bill is not merely a response to an environmental crisis; it is a strategic roadmap for a resilient Zimbabwe that values transparency, fiscal prudence and the empowerment of its local communities.

Transparency and Rigorous Oversight

A critical pillar of this legislation is found in Clause 13, which establishes the reporting requirements that will hold our climate actions to account. While the initial draft proposed a five-year reporting cycle, I stand with the stakeholders who have called for a more urgent, biennial approach. In a world where environmental shifts happen with startling speed, a two-year reporting cycle to Parliament ensures that we remain agile and that our progress or lack thereof, is subject to regular and rigorous legislative scrutiny. This is about building a culture of

transparency that ensures our climate goals are not just promises on paper but measurable achievements.

Public Engagement and Institutional Efficiency

Furthermore, Clauses 15 and 16 recognise that for any climate strategy to succeed, it must possess a "social licence". This Bill correctly frames climate management as a social exercise that requires continuous public and stakeholder engagement. To achieve this without placing an undue burden on the taxpayer, I support the pragmatic proposal to leverage the existing expertise of Environmental Management Agency (EMA) officers. By creating a collaborative framework between the department and the EMA, we avoid the pitfalls of a bloated civil service while ensuring that our climate policies are implemented by those who already understand the local terrain.

Economic Deterrence and Resource Management

Clause 21 which establishes the National Emissions Trading System and Levy, provides the necessary "teeth" to our environmental aspirations. It ensures that large-scale emitters are held financially accountable for their carbon footprint. However, as we implement this

system, especially in our mining-heavy districts like Buhera, we must ensure there is no jurisdictional confusion. By mandating strong collaboration between the Climate Change Management Department and the EMA, we can ensure that our air quality and waste management standards are unified and that those who profit from our natural resources contribute fairly to the cost of their protection.

Community Wealth and Technological Innovation

Finally, I wish to highlight Clause 22 which deals with technology development and innovation. We must view "Technology Transfer" not just as a technical exchange but as a social partnership. When new green technologies are deployed on communal land, be it solar farms or biogas digesters, the people living on that land must be more than mere spectators. I strongly support the recommendation that such innovation projects be legally bound to include a 40% community share. By utilising standardised "Model Trust Deeds," we can ensure that these funds are managed transparently and that the benefits of the green transition flow directly into the hands of the rural communities that host them.

In conclusion, this Bill offers a profound opportunity to align our national economy with global best practices while keeping it firmly anchored in the lived realities of our people. It is a Bill that promotes growth, demands accountability and most importantly, ensures that as we move toward a low-carbon future, we truly leave no one and no place behind. I thank you.

HON. CHIDUWA: Thank you, Madam Speaker Ma'am. I rise to express my support for the Zimbabwe Climate Change Management Bill. The legislation, as was presented, marks a decisive step in translating our climate commitments into concrete, bankable actions that will protect lives, safeguard livelihoods and grow our economy in a sustainable and low-carbon path. Madam Speaker, if you look at the history in terms of our commitments, where we are coming from as a country, captured in the Transitional Stabilisation Programme, the NDS 1 and even the NDS 2, there is clarity in terms of what we want to achieve as a country. We have shown that as a country we can develop but at the same time taking into account the health of our environment.

So, Madam Speaker, let me briefly comment on the development that is linked to low-carbon development. Our NDS 2, Vision 2030, takes into account sustainable development and sustainable development is considering the issue of dealing with our environment. The Bill enshrines a national strategy to decarbonise key sectors like energy, transport, industry and the environment.

Madam Speaker, if you look at our industry, yes, we have coal resources, our electricity generation is dependent on coal and then the hydrocarbon. What we have said as a country is inasmuch as we are going to be a signatory to some of the international treaties but when it comes to the utilisation of our resources to develop our country, I think this is supposed to be acknowledged. We must make sure that we are not going to be governed by those who do not have the power to dictate that we should not use coal. The competitive and comparative advantage that we have as a country now is that we have coal and electricity and energy is what we need.

Fertilizer can come from coal, electricity from coal and yes, as we proceed, we are looking at the decarbonisation of our development

agenda but at the same time taking into account the competitive advantages that we have. Then the issue of resilience, Madam Speaker, we have seen disasters that are happening in our communities. If you look at the Bill, it is taking into account the development plans that are looking at how we construct our roads, how we construct our schools, our clinics and our farms in line with the vagaries of weather that we witness almost yearly. I am saying that when communities are insulated against weather shocks, this is provided for in the Bill. It is provided that the vulnerable communities have priority in terms of access and then also in terms of funding, making sure that the communities have access to resources, including capacity building programmes. Then, on funding, Madam Speaker, we are happy with the Bill, which looks at the climate change management department coordinating across Ministries.

This is in line with the whole of Government approach, which has been alluded to earlier, that yes, the Climate Fund is there but we are going to pool all the resources in one fund, which will then be used to fund our development priorities. Then the other issue is on governance,

where we are saying the Bill embeds participatory governance, which also takes into account the views that are coming from civil society.

So, I support the Bill, Madam Speaker, but there are one or two issues where I think we may need to consider on the issue of penalties and offences. Madam Speaker, I think there is a need for us to take into account issues where there is false reporting, which leads to carbon fraud and misuse of funds. It is needed that we need to criminalise this and there is also a need for strong enforcement that will allow us to make sure that we are not going to see those who commit carbon fraud. Madam Speaker, there is also the issue of vulnerable groups.

The Bill may not expressly prioritise women, the youth, persons with disabilities and those who are displaced because of climate. I think there is a need for us to have somewhere where we expressly capture the vulnerable groups that may be affected by climate change. Then, on the issue of Zimbabwe having a weak carbon market, there is a need for us as a country to make sure that our carbon market is going to be guided by strict rules. I am saying this because if we undervalue our carbon credits, we are going to be vulnerable to foreign exploitation and what is

called greenwashing. So, our rules must be watertight to ensure that as a country, we are not going to be exposed to weak carbon market deals.

Then last but not least is the issue of devolution, ensuring that carbon credit markets empower local authorities. Climate issues impact local authorities, people who are on the ground and I think there is a need for us to ensure that the councils and the provinces are not left out. This will ensure that as we benefit from the fund, the local authorities at the district and provincial levels are not left out.

Madam Speaker, with these submissions, I support the Bill and I am sure that the Bill is going to result in institutions that are going to deliver tangible, inclusive and sustainable action for Zimbabwe. I so submit.

HON. DHANZI: Thank you Madam Speaker for giving me this opportunity. I rise to offer my full and unwavering support for the Climate Change Management Bill. This is not merely a technical document; it is a bridge between the complexities of international climate finance and the lived realities of our people. By supporting these clauses, we are empowering Zimbabweans to take ownership of their

environmental testing and ensuring that our transition to a green economy is inclusive of youth, women and people with disabilities. The strength of this Bill lies in its commitment to decentralisation as clearly outlined in Clauses 9 to 12. We must move beyond a Harare-centric administration that often feels distant from the frontlines of environmental change by deploying climate change officers to all the ten provinces. We are ensuring that the devolution mantra is transformed from a slogan into a practical, localised reality for our rural communities.

Furthermore, we must recognise that our young people are our most creative assets who have the greatest stake in our climate future. I applaud the recommendation to mandate youth representation within these departmental units. Bringing their fresh ideas into provincial governance ensures that our climate strategies remain both innovative and sustainable. However, for this to work, we must ensure these provincial officers have the tip to act. I support the call to grant them the power to inspect, not only industrial sites but also large-scale

commercial developments, ensuring emissions compliance and enforced at the local level where it matters most.

Public engagement; turning to the human element of this legislation, Clause 16 is truly the heart of the Bill. It recognises that climate management is a social exercise and a matter of social justice, not a technical box-ticking activity. For this legislation to carry a social licence, we must embrace the Committee's observation that public participation must be a continuously evolving process. To truly ensure we leave no one and no place behind, we must break down the barriers of communication.

I strongly support the recommendation that all climate policies and strategies be translated into local languages and distributed across every province. The participation is an impossibility if our citizens cannot read and understand the very laws that affect their livelihoods and health.

Finally, we must be as fiscally responsible as we are environmentally cautious. To avoid the pitfalls of a bloated civil service, I support the proposal for the Climate Change Management Department to leverage existing Environmental Management Agency (EMA)

officers through a collaborative framework. This approach ensures that we utilise our current human resources and expertise efficiently to meet these new agent national challenges without unnecessary barriers overlapping. I thank you.

HON. TOGAREPI: I move that the debate do now adjourn.

HON. C. MOYO: I second.

Motion put and agreed to.

Debate to resume: Tuesday, 28th April, 2026.

On the motion of **HON. TOGAREPI**, *seconded by* **HON. C. MOYO,** *the House adjourned at Eleven Minutes past Five o'clock p.m. until Tuesday, 28th April, 2026.*